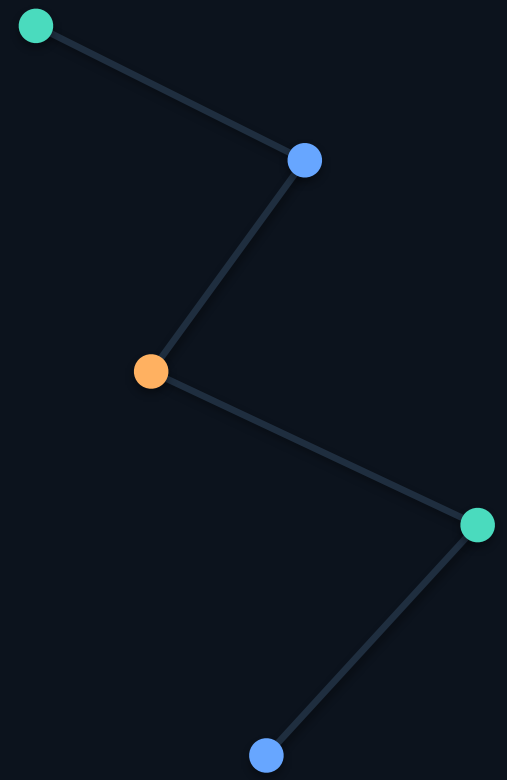
PRODUCT STRATEGY CASE STUDY | TRAVEL COMMERCE

# From travel inspiration

to trips people can actually book



A concept-led case study in customer journey design, competitive positioning and product growth.

INDEPENDENT CONCEPT STUDY • NOT A LIVE LAUNCH

Portfolio case study | October 2026

STRATEGY • PRODUCT • GROWTH

# Turning travel inspiration into a bookable journey.

A product strategy concept exploring how an established travel platform could reduce friction between discovery, planning and purchase.

### The challenge

Travel inspiration is distributed across creators, reviews, saved posts and destination guides. Translating it into a complete, bookable trip can require multiple disconnected steps.

### The opportunity

Explore a single journey that connects inspiration, itinerary composition and booking within an existing travel platform.

### The approach

Map the customer journey, scan direct and adjacent competitors, define a differentiated concept, then outline a measurable proof of concept.

**Scope: strategic concept and validation plan. This is not a shipped product or a claim of measured impact.**

# The friction sits between “that looks amazing” and “trip booked.”

Journey hypothesis to validate through interviews, usability testing and platform data.

01

## Discover

A creator, friend or review sparks a travel idea.

→

02

## Assemble

Places, stays, transport and activities live in different places.

→

03

## Personalise

Adapt the plan to dates, budget and group needs.

→

04

## Book

Translate the plan into available products and transactions.

→

05

## Manage

Coordinate changes, confirmations and logistics.

**Design opportunity: reduce the effort required to turn a high-intent idea into a coherent, bookable plan.**

# Build on the travel engine. Focus innovation on the customer journey.

The concept is designed for a scaled travel marketplace with existing distribution, supply and fulfilment capabilities.

### Distribution

Use existing app and web journeys, customer relationships and brand reach.

### Supply and fulfilment

Connect plans to live inventory, booking, payments and service operations where available.

### Data and experimentation

Test adoption and incremental conversion against a baseline, with operational guardrails.

**Strategic thesis: improve the path to booking without rebuilding the travel stack.**

# A flexible itinerary that moves from inspiration to action.

Proposed experience direction. The final feature set would depend on research, technical feasibility and host-platform overlap.

## ONE CONNECTED TRAVEL JOURNEY

### Discover

Creator stories, trip templates and trusted recommendations.

### Compose

Build a day-by-day plan with routes, timings, budget and alternatives.

### Book

Connect itinerary elements to live availability and existing booking flows.

## DESIGN PRINCIPLES

- Useful before monetisation
- Personalised, not prescriptive
- Availability-aware
- Easy to share and revise
- Integrated with existing booking

*Concept direction only. No claim is made that any target platform lacks similar capabilities.*

# The market is active across inspiration, planning and booking.

A directional scan of direct and adjacent players helps define the problem space. It is not a full feature audit.

## Creator-led travel

GetSetYo, Fleeps and Weno

Creator or advisor profiles, travel advice, shareable itineraries and booking pathways.

## Itinerary and booking

Pickyourtrail and major OTAs

Custom trip plans, package assembly, pricing and booking support.

## Discovery and guidance

Tripadvisor, Viaje and concierge-led services such as Scenset

Reviews, destination guidance, AI-assisted planning or human support.

**Positioning hypothesis: a native, editable itinerary connected to host-platform inventory, evaluated on customer utility and incremental conversion.**

# Define success through customer and commercial outcomes.

Metrics are proposed for a future pilot. No performance results are claimed in this concept study.

### Acquisition and activation

Do itineraries attract new users or activate customers who have not yet booked?

### Conversion and basket

Does the journey improve search-to-book conversion, attach rate or booking value?

### Retention and trust

Do users return to plan again, complete trips with fewer issues and recommend the experience?

**Primary outcome: incremental contribution after discounts, supplier costs, support, cancellations and cannibalisation.**

# A 90-day path from hypothesis to a scale-or-stop decision.

Illustrative plan. Timing depends on engineering capacity, integration complexity and internal approvals.

WEEKS 1-2

## Discover

Interview customers; map journeys; audit competitor experiences and technical feasibility.

WEEKS 3-4

## Prototype

Build a clickable prototype; define scope, events, cohort and guardrails.

WEEKS 5-9

## Pilot

Run a narrow MVP or assisted test and measure usage and booking outcomes.

WEEKS 10-12

## Evaluate

Assess incrementality, customer feedback, operational impact and next investment.

**Decision gate: ship a testable proof of concept, then use evidence to iterate, scale or stop.**

# Treat the opportunity like an internal venture.

An Entrepreneur-in-Residence model could combine entrepreneurial ownership with the resources and governance of an established platform.

## Opportunity owner

Problem validation and product thesis
Feature vision and prioritisation
Customer and creator discovery
Cross-functional delivery
Pilot readout and recommendation

## Host-platform support

Executive sponsor
Lean engineering and design pod
Access to relevant data and teams
Pilot audience and internal partners
Technical, legal and commercial guardrails

## Agree before build

Decision rights and boundaries
POC deliverable and review date
Baseline and success metrics
IP and confidentiality terms
Milestone-linked incentives, where applicable

**Autonomy in execution. Collaboration on architecture. Accountability for evidence and outcomes.**

# A concept is only useful if it can be validated and delivered.

My approach combines brand, growth, partnerships and cross-functional execution. The portfolio version should pair this with selected proof points.

### Problem ownership

Start with a customer friction point and turn it into a testable product thesis.

### Commercial thinking

Connect the experience to adoption, conversion, contribution and operating costs.

### Evidence-led delivery

Define a narrow test, agree success criteria and use results to earn further investment.

*Suggested portfolio enhancement: add 2 to 3 verified achievements from prior roles that demonstrate measurable execution.*

# The concept could be explored with different travel platforms.

These are potential strategic contexts, not confirmed partners or evidence of an active EIR programme.

### MakeMyTrip

Broad India travel marketplace. Potential lens: journey innovation and incremental booking conversion.

### EaseMyTrip

Mass-market booking platform. Potential lens: differentiated planning and cross-sell.

### Agoda

Global accommodation-led platform. Potential lens: destination planning and lodging conversion, subject to feature scope.

**Each platform would require a tailored assessment of existing features, customer needs, technical fit and economics.**

# Validate the problem before committing to the build.

The next step is discovery and a bounded proof of concept, not a commitment to a full product vertical.

DISCOVERY SPRINT

## Validate the customer problem, assess feature overlap and test strategic fit with one host platform.

- Interview target customers
- Review current platform journeys
- Select a narrow use case
- Define baseline, metrics and guardrails

DECISION GATE

## Is the problem material enough to test?

If evidence supports the opportunity, resource a focused pilot and measure incremental value.

# Direct and adjacent players shape the opportunity space.

Directional desk research based on public product descriptions. Not a comprehensive feature-by-feature audit.

## Market categories

- Creator-led advice and itinerary commerce: GetSetYo, Fleeps, Weno
- Custom itinerary building and booking: Pickyourtrail
- Travel discovery, reviews and destination guidance: Tripadvisor
- AI-assisted travel planning and creator community: Viaje
- Concierge-led trip planning: Scenset
- Potential host platforms: MakeMyTrip, EaseMyTrip, Agoda

## Questions for validation

- Is the customer pain frequent and material?
- What features already exist in target platforms?
- What do competing experiences enable today?
- What is the integration effort?
- Are unit economics incremental after costs?
- What sponsorship and operating model is viable?

Public sources: fleeps.co | weno.travel/for-creators | pickyourtrail.com/itineraries | tripadvisor.com | viaje.in | scenset.com | makemytrip.com/about-us.php | getsetyo.com

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